

EDUCATION

Oregon State University

Corvallis, United States

*Ph.D. in Computer Science*2023 - 2029 (*expected*)

- Advisor: Prof. Huazheng Wang
- Research Area: Robust LLMs Reasoning and Decision Making & Agentic AI

Zhuhai College of Jilin University

Zhuhai, China

B.E. in Data Science

2019 - 2023

- GPA: 3.84/4.00, Rank: 1/249
- First-tier Academic Performance Scholarship for 3 consecutive years
- Outstanding Graduate Award, 2023
- Thesis: Semi-Supervised Deep Learning on Computer Vision Tasks

PUBLICATIONS

1. Yaoyao Qian, **Yifan Zeng**, Yuchao Jiang, Chelsi Jain, Huazheng Wang. **The Ranking Blind Spot: Decision Hijacking in LLM-based Text Ranking**, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2509.18575*, 2025. ([EMNLP 2025](#))
2. Chelsi Jain, Yiran Wu, **Yifan Zeng**, Jiale Liu, Shengyu Dai, Zhenwen Shao, Qingyun Wu, Huazheng Wang. **SimpleDoc: Multi-Modal Document Understanding with Dual-Cue Page Retrieval and Iterative Refinement**, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.14035*, 2025. ([EMNLP 2025](#))
3. Jiale Liu, **Yifan Zeng**, Yifan Zeng, Shaokun Zhang, Chi Zhang, Malte Højmark-Bertelsen, Marie Normann Gadeberg, Huazheng Wang, Qingyun Wu. **Divide, Optimize, Merge: Fine-Grained LLM Agent Optimization at Scale**, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2505.03973*, 2025. ([EMNLP 2025](#))
4. Jiahao Qiu, Yifu Lu, **Yifan Zeng**, Jiacheng Guo, Jiayi Geng, Huazheng Wang, Kaixuan Huang, Yue Wu, Mengdi Wang. **TreeBoN: Enhancing Inference-Time Alignment with Speculative Tree-Search and Best-of-N Sampling**, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.16033*, 2024. ([EMNLP 2025](#))
5. Hui Yuan, **Yifan Zeng**, Yue Wu, Huazheng Wang, Mengdi Wang, Liu Leqi. **A Common Pitfall of Margin-based Language Model Alignment: Gradient Entanglement**, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2410.13828*, 2024. ([ICLR 2025](#))
6. **Yifan Zeng**, Ojas Tendolkar, Raymond Baartmans, Qingyun Wu, Lizhong Chen, Huazheng Wang. **LLM-RankFusion: Mitigating Intrinsic Inconsistency in LLM-based Ranking**, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2406.00231*, 2024. ([NeurIPS 2024 Workshop SFLLM](#))
7. **Yifan Zeng**, Yiran Wu, Xiao Zhang, Huazheng Wang, Qingyun Wu. **AutoDefense: Multi-Agent LLM Defense against Jailbreak Attacks**, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2403.04783*, 2024. ([NeurIPS 2024 Workshop SafeGenAI](#))
8. Jianqi Yan, Junjie Luo, **Yifan Zeng**, Alex P Leung, Jie Feng, Hong-Hao Zhang, Weipeng Lin. **Modeling the Time Evolution of Compact Binary Systems with Machine Learning**, *The Astrophysical Journal* 973 (2), 163, 2024.
9. Jianqi Yan, **Yifan Zeng**, Junhong Lin, Jinrui Fan, Chuanyu Fang, Yong Cai. **Enhanced Object Detection in Pediatric Bronchoscopy Images using YOLO-based Algorithms with CBAM Attention Mechanism**, *Heliyon* 10 (12), 2024.
10. Wei Lv, Tao Chen, **Yifan Zeng**, Weihong Liu, Chuying Huang. **A challenge of deep-learning-based object detection for hair follicle dataset**, *Journal of Cosmetic Dermatology* 22 (9), 2565-2578, 2023.
11. **Yifan Zeng**, Aohui Pang, Wei Lv, Xiaolin Zhu. **Task-Level Consistency Semi-Supervised Based Domain Adaptation for Lung Nodules Segmentation**, *Computer and Information Science*, 181-196, 2022.

PROJECTS	Importance Sampling Optimization Improves Online Preference Learning	Under Review at ICLR 2026
	<i>Yifan Zeng, Haoyu Zhao, Huazheng Wang</i>	
	Railway Defect Detection via Self-Supervised Learning on Ultrasound Data	2022.09 - 2023.12
	<i>Quanbao Network Technology Co., Ltd.</i>	
EXPERIENCE	Context-Aware Video Object Detection on Medical Tasks	2022.03 - 2023.12
	<i>Quanbao Network Technology Co., Ltd.</i>	
	Research Assistant Oregon State University	2025.09 - Now
	AI Agent Research Intern AG2AI	2025.06 - 2025.09
	Developing agentic AI systems that can process, analyze, and interact with various environments.	
	Teaching Assistant Oregon State University	2024.09 - 2025.06
	- CS 550 - Introduction to Computer Graphics - CS 512 - Data Science Tools and Programming - CS 546 - Networks in Computational Biology - CS 312 - System Administration	
	Research Assistant Oregon State University	2024.03 - 2024.09
	Research Scientist Quanbao Network Technology Co. Ltd.	2022.04 - 2023.08
	- Developed novel semi-supervised learning algorithms and architectures to tackle complex domain-specific visual recognition tasks with limited labeled data - Led research collaborations with medical institutions and railway corporation, delivering SOTA solutions for medical imaging analysis and industrial defect detection	
SERVICE	SWE Intern Zhuhai Xiangyi Aviation Technology Co. Ltd.	2021.10 - 2022.01
	- Designed data analysis and visualization solutions for pilot training - Led the development of a pilot training tracking platform	
SKILLS	Reviewer ICLR 2026, WWW 2025, AAAI 2025, EMNLP 2025	
	Expertise: - Distributed Online RL Training for LLM Agents (e.g., GRPO with Verl) - Building LLM Agents: LLM for Information Retrieval, Information Seeking Agent - RLHF Pipeline: SFT, Reward Model Training, Preference Optimization (with TRL) - Self-Supervised Representation Learning, Object Detection for Vision Tasks	